

Student response

The poem deals with nostalgia for childhood and the passage of time. The author remembers his birthplace and feels he cannot return to that stage of life.

The poem uses a metaphor when time is compared with a river that never returns. It also uses anaphora by repeating the word 'remember' at the start of several lines to emphasize the importance of the past.

In conclusion, a melancholy tone and these literary devices reinforce the main theme.